

Self-expression

There are many different ways for people to convey who they are—and appearance is one of them. Teens might find creativity, individuality, and connection with their peers based on how they express themselves through their appearance.

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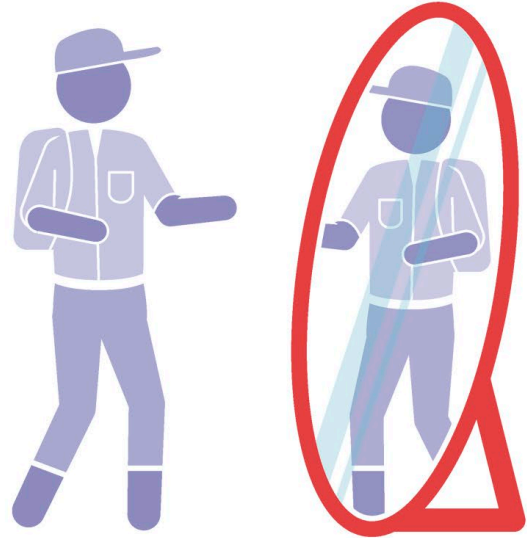
Appearance

When people feel good about their appearance, it can make them feel more positive and confident. Receiving compliments from others can also help to boost confidence. However, sometimes the reactions people get may not be what they'd hoped for. Unfortunately, some people can be prejudiced toward those who do things differently from them—including dressing differently.

It can be easy for teens to fall into the trap of dressing to please other people, rather than themselves, but it is best for people to remain authentic and honest in all that they do—including how they look.

▷ Looking good

Self-expression, feeling good, and self-acceptance all go hand-in-hand.



△ Trying new things

Exploring different looks can give teens the chance to figure out not just what they like, but also how they want other people to perceive them.

Experimentation

It can be fulfilling to experiment with appearance, as figuring out what makes an individual look and feel their best can take time. After all, going through puberty is a process, and so as teens grow and mature, it makes sense for them to try different looks. There's no harm in an individual playing with the way that they look over time, or even day-to-day. It can allow people to get to know themselves better, which in turn helps others to understand them better, too.

TEEN HINTS

Dealing with disapproval

You might find you often disagree with your parents about what you wear or how you look. This happens because parents generally focus on how others will judge or stereotype a person based on how they look. You, on the other hand, might value creativity, individuality, and being accepted by friends much more highly. If your appearance regularly becomes a topic of conflict, try discussing these different values calmly with each other. Some might be more important than others in different situations.